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**r/GooglePixel** • 1y ago
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Recently, there's been a growing movement against Google, urging people to 'de-Google' their lives for privacy reasons. For those of you who are deeply immersed in the Google ecosystem, what do you think about this?

I'm considering switching from an iPhone to a Google Pixel, but I've heard that iPhones are generally more secure than Android devices, and Google's reputation when it comes to privacy isn't great.

That said, I still use Gmail, Google Calendar, Drive, etc.

What are your thoughts on these concerns?"



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176

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✓ \$8,500/year
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**[deleted]** • 1y ago

I don't trust any major organisation with my data, but I'm 20 years deep into the internet, too late now 🤔



329

**AntiDebug** • 1y ago

Pretty much my view on the matter. I have tried to remove myself from some parts of the big organizations. I run Linux now instead of Windows and I don't use Google Search or Chrome. But I have a Google Pixel and I use Gmail.

Basically Im trying to cut out the big companies bit by bit but Im not fanatical about it. If I can find an alternative I like, then great, If not, oh well.



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**[deleted]** • 1y ago

I'm slowly diversifying it all, anything stored in the cloud, I'm bringing locally too, trying to delete accounts I no longer use....the amount of subject access requests I've sent 🤪

**keikioaina** • 1y ago

This is the way. Also long rando passwords from Bitwarden.



7 more replies

**framingXjake** • 1y ago

You can always flash GrapheneOS to your pixel to de-google it.



11 more replies

**bemy_requiem** • 1y ago

Try Protonmail, I made the switch and it's super easy and much better

**AntiDebug** • 1y ago

I have an account. But storage is so much less than Google. I could probably make it work if I was a bit more diligent with deleting stuff.

**bemy_requiem** • 1y ago

I suppose, though my Google storage had only just become full on the email I used since I was 10 (11 years ago), and that's with all the crap I signed up to spamming me. For me the features of Protonmail more than make up for the storage, and at the end of the day the lowest tier subscription is only £3/month (you also get to use a personal domain, which imo everyone should have).



1 more reply



3 more replies



4 more replies

**americangame** • 1y ago

Pick your giant corporate overlord and run with it. Will it be Google, Apple, Microsoft, Amazon, or Meta?

[Skip to main content](#)[+ Create](#)**wase471111** • 1y ago

well said, the privacy ship has sailed ages ago, so minimize your exposure as much as you can, but once the google/micro/amazon/crapple overlords have your info, there is no going "anonymous" anymore., **PERIOD**

[+ 1 more reply](#)[+ 5 more replies](#)**whatstefansees** • 1y ago

Google and Apple both live by exploiting your personal data. Google offers more choice and better phones right now

**m00ph** • 1y ago

Apple's turning to the dark side, that sweet advertising and enshitification money. A year or two ago, I'd have gone to Apple for my next device, but I don't see much point now as a long term Google and Android user, they'll be here soon enough. I am thinking about the degoogled stuff, it's very tempting, Google will wipe everything you have in an instant with zero recourse.

**blazincannons** • 1y ago

Pixel 4a

Regarding privacy, in what terms is what Apple doing worse nowadays compared to years before? I have not been following much regarding Apple privacy stuff.

**CoMiGa** • 1y ago

Pixel 8 Pro

Apple has been the dark side for a long time.

**Saragon4005** • 1y ago

A real fucking shame, cuz they extorted their customers but did offer a bastion of privacy with a convenience not found elsewhere.

It was bad enough with Windows putting ADs in the launcher yet no free teir (officially)

[+ 9 more replies](#)**disagree_agree** • 1y ago

Google also has more of an incentive to create features to push users into handing over more data as a greater percentage of revenue comes from advertising.

[Skip to main content](#)[+ Create](#)**GorillaHeat** • 1y ago

Pixel 6 Pro

Privacy is gone. Every single company you coming to contact with is selling your information. Your credit card companies... Netflix... The grocery store you shop at, any company that asks you for your ZIP code after you're done purchasing something. Any company that has a loyalty rewards program.

If you "de-google" you're not really achieving much.

**SkittleHodl** • 1y ago

Yep. The data brokers are way worse than any smartphone manufacturer and OS vendor.

[+ 1 more reply](#)**Wolf-Am-I** • 1y ago

One of my vehicles is a BMW. Read through the terms on the BMW app and basically they track you, and your habits... I'm sure they sell it to insurance companies 🤖. There's no escaping it at this point. You can work very diligently to minimize, but if you enjoy any sort of connected modern experience, it's a futile effort.

**dglsfrsr** • 1y ago

I am not sure on the new models, but on the 2020 and older Fords, you can disable the data, as long as you don't want to use the MyFord app. Just use the damn key! I don't need to unlock or remote start the car with my phone.

You have to step into the setup menus to turn it off, but you can

[+ 2 more replies](#)**carpesalmon** • 1y ago • Edited 1y ago

You're achieving meaningfully more privacy than you were previously. Even incremental small gains are better than nothing. Don't let perfect be the enemy of good.

Even something as simple as changing your default DNS to something more privacy respecting will increase your privacy and security (recommend AdGuard which is free).

Edit: had AdGuard and Quad9 confused.

<https://adguard-dns.io/en/public-dns.html>

**zakazak** • 1y ago

P8P P6P P4XL

Please don't use AdGuard. I debunked their Android App on their GitHub as a privacy invasion

[Skip to main content](#)[+ Create](#)**rukzak** • 1y ago

Can you please share a link to your debunk?

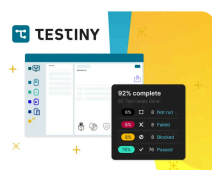
[+ 1 more reply](#)**Skulkaa** • 1y ago

Pixel 8 Pro

Isn't the Adguard also Russian owned ?

[+ 3 more replies](#)[+ 7 more replies](#)[+ 1 more reply](#)**u/TestinyApp** • Promoted

Test management that doesn't suck. Lightweight, fast, and built for real dev teams.

**TESTINY**

Easy to use. Lightning fast.
Supports test automation.
Integrates with any tool.
Use in cloud or on-premises.

testiny.io[Sign Up](#)**yet-another-username** • 1y ago • Edited 1y ago

No company cares about your privacy. Not Google, not Apple.

I've been wanting to degoogle my life for a while, to do it properly you should treat it as 'declouding' your life where ever possible. Just moving everything to another cloud provider is just moving the problem.

Honestly it's a lot of effort and I haven't been able to prioritize it yet

**carpsalmon** • 1y ago

Settings > Network and Internet > Private DNS > enter `dns.adguard-dns.com` then enjoy substantially fewer online ads

[Source](#)

**carpsalmon** • 1y ago

Or if anti-adguard, mullvad's is really good too: `adblock.dns.mullvad.net`

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Pixel 9 Pro XL

Why one, why the other?

I used to use NextDNS and now I'm using adguard, because I got the subscription to the adblock on Windows so, I tried the DNS (the public one) and is okay



carpessalmon • 1y ago

AdGuard can be poorly received by some, perhaps due to it being a russian company.

NextDNS has a quota of 300k per month for with free accounts but does require an account. (I use a paid version)

Mullvad's is free and has no quota and is Swedis.

For a better comparison I recommend privacyguides.org



dglsfrsr • 1y ago

Pihole. Local, in my house, easy to add both local blacklist and whitelist.



chisav • 1y ago

Pihole is nice until it breaks something and your wife is tripping balls because none her crap is loading.



bigtoepfer • 1y ago

Nexus 5 | Pixel | Pixel 3

This is exactly why my pihole/pi is in the closet not hooked up right now.



1 more reply



zakazak • 1y ago

P8P P6P P4XL

Please don't use AdGuard. I debunked their Android App on their GitHub as a privacy invasion freak tool and never got an answer. Quad9 or NextDNS or DNSCrypt it is. Preferable DNSCrypt.



21 more replies



bringbackcayde7 • 1y ago

Most google services are free, so the personal data you provide them is pretty much the product

[Skip to main content](#)[Create](#)

are just kidding yourself.



elwebst • 1y ago

Yes - and keep your money in a Folgers can in the garage, under a bunch nails, like my grandpappy taught me to.

/s



u/vlad-x • Promoted

Stop staring at YouTube for viral topics. Get a video blueprint from real hot trends..

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[tubescore.app](#)



BallerGuitarer • 1y ago

I started by de-Googleing myself from Photos, mostly because I'm sick of subscription creep. Leaving Gmail and Calendar are going to be much harder.



zakazak • 1y ago

P8P P6P P4XL

IMAPsync to move all mails. Regarding calenders I am thinking about self hosted Nextcloud maybe.



WhiskeyWithTheE • 1y ago

[Etesync](#) for Calendar and Tasks and Contacts is worth a try - it's a paid for service - encrypted - but it saved me the faff of Davx5

Proton Calendar isn't mature enough - I had a fair few issues using this (This was over a year ago though)



[deleted] • 1y ago



4 more replies



Orthopraxy • 1y ago

My Pixel runs [GraphineOS](#), so I guess you could call me a "de-googler" even if I'm not specifically doing it for that reason.

[Skip to main content](#)[+ Create](#)**ajosefox** • 1y ago

How's your experience with Graphene been? I'm an iOS user considering giving this a shot.

**Orthopraxy** • 1y ago

Can't speak to the experience of coming from iOS, but aside from the Google Play store being uninstalled by default it's pretty identical to stock Android IMO. No real difference aside from having to side-load apps

**KDao18** • 1y ago

Pixel 8

Can you still be able to use RCS messaging on Graphene? Or is it still the sad SMS?

**Youngnathan2011** • 1y ago

It'd still be regular old SMS. Only real way they'd get RCS is by using the Google Messages app. And while the app would be sandboxed, still having to use a Google account wouldn't be great if one's going for privacy

**Strong-Annual-5732** • 1y ago

Sure it would. Google cannot read your E2EE RCS messages. They don't even possess a key to decrypt them if some authority demanded them. It's as safe, secure, and private as iMessage and in some ways more so.

[+ 1 more reply](#)**psyact** • 1y ago

What device are you using?

I have been playing around with GrapheneOS on an old Pixel 5 I had lying around, and I was surprised at how easy it was to replicate virtually everything I do on my main phone with OSS.

Thinking about putting it on my main phone, a P9P, but I'm wondering if there are any other quirks I'm missing. I know banking apps are problematic and I'd have to move away from Wallets, but those aren't dealbreakers if I can break off from the big three by a decent amount (Google, Microsoft, and Amazon).

[+ 1 more reply](#)

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and am not 100% degoogled, its just to hard for some apps. But still it gives you more control over your phone. Like the others said, every step towards privacy is the right one. Give it a shot!

[+ 3 more replies](#)



jbarr107 • 1y ago

Pixel 8a

I've been deep in the Google ecosystem since getting a beta invite to the Gmail pilot in 2004. No turning back now.



zakazak • 1y ago

P8P P6P P4XL

That is my problem as well but I think it's easier than thought. IMAPSync to sync all mails to my new (self hosted?) provider in a few minutes. Calenders can be exported. Contacts can be exported. What else there is?



Starbomba • 1y ago

Pixel 8 Pro

The only true way to be private and for no company to know what you do... is to not use any phone of any brand, to not use anything that connects to the internet in any way, and to not have anyone in your household do so. All of that is an impossibility unless you go totally off grid.

I used to worry about that before, but now it is futile, so I do not worry too much. At most I keep safe by not going to suspicious websites, using secure devices with the latest updates, and using a good password manager, multiple factor authentication and common sense.



blastedgun • 1y ago

Already too late for that, the government also has their data. If they wanted "TRUE" privacy then they needed to be born outside of society. Perhaps tribes?



dglsfrsr • 1y ago

You go to Reddit! (lol....)



Hotchi_Motchi • 1y ago

Elon Musk's 22-year-old minions have my social security number and banking information, so why should I worry about Google?



pbetc • 1y ago

[Skip to main content](#)[Create](#)**rkpjr** • 1y ago

That's the guy



2 more replies

**SeatSix** • 1y ago

Top 1% Commenter

Secure and private are different. Secure means protected against malicious software. It's pretty much even here. As long as you have the latest versions and updates and practice good security skills, they are both secure.

Private is about how much data is collected and what is done with it. Here again, things are even at least in terms of data corrected. Both capture a lot of telemetry (days in the state of the device and what you're doing with it). Things get a little different with how that is used. Google is primarily an advertisement company. That is the bulk of their revenue, so they sell the data they collect to companies so they can target ads. It's anonymized, in that a company would not get your name, but that's how you search for something and suddenly all the ads in your feeds are for that thing.

Apple collects just as much data (maybe more as you can opt out of less, though Microsoft collects the most). But remember, your carrier is collecting a ton also.

So, it is basically a wash between mainstream Android and iOS. If you really want to cut data collected on you, custom ROMs like GrapheneOS with Google Play services not installed would be the way to go (but then you lost things like banking apps). And extreme would be a degoogled GrapheneOS phone with no SIM (relying on wifi with a VPN) for connectivity so carriers couldn't track your usage.

Absolute would be not to be connected at all.

So, privacy is about balancing what you want to do with the device with how much you are willing to share (or can risk to share).

**briang416** • 1y ago

Pixel 9 Pro

A lot of banking apps do work with GrapheneOS, Google Pay does not however, but you should be using cash anyway if you don't want to be tracked.



1 more reply

**[deleted]** • 1y ago

Part of me wants to say "fuck it" and go back to a flip phone and an iPod. I feel as though I was truly happiest and had the best relationship with my tech in the mid-late aughts.



1 more reply

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system.

[+](#) 2 more replies



vawlk • 1y ago

Pixel 5

if you don't trust Google, then you should just go offline as no corporation should really be trusted these days.

I'll just continue to do what i have been.



thegorilla09 • 1y ago

Pixels are good, simple, reliable, affordable, and secure.

If you're worried about privacy, don't get a smartphone. Alternatively, don't install social media apps. You can use web apps. Also, install adguard.



[deleted] • 1y ago

I'm in the process of switching to Proton.



Besonderein • 1y ago

I'm deep in the Google ecosystem and I'm fine with my choices. If I were into nefarious things, I'd probably use other tech for that. But if they wanna know what temp I like my house or how long my TV is on or when I'm at the gym, I don't really care.

[+](#) 1 more reply



kezopster • 1y ago

Pixel 10 Pro XL

Eh, Google's privacy policies are near the bottom of my worry list.



KingLuis • 1y ago

If you are so worried about your privacy, you wouldn't have any type of account on the internet. Including Reddit. You probably already have a Google account and many others, you are already tracked and have had your information sold. It's too late now. People have been trying to de google or go offline as much as they can but never really do.

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dinner aware plant familiar water unite bag seemly special advise

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[deleted] • 1y ago

Google va apple doesn't matter. If you store your data in the cloud the government does not need to subpoena anyone to get your data in the cloud. If you care about that then you are stuck in the dilemma of false choice. If you don't care then it doesn't matter. Encryption on device doesn't matter if the same data is stored in the cloud.

Different apps like signal, telegram, etc data may or may not be stored on your phone or in a providers cloud and they are the gate keeper to the data in the app, but as soon as any of it is I saved unencrypted to your phone, it might as well be available to the DA and the police FBI/CIA.

If you do care, then your option is to host your own cloud services in your home or in a secure location (some data centers will give LEO physical access to your server with or without a subpoena. Then you have to use those apps in a way that is consistent with how you value your privacy. If you sync the data to your phone and your phone backs it up RIP it's now in the cloud and you are once again stuck in a false dilemma of choice.



briang416 • 1y ago

Pixel 9 Pro

With the enhanced security option that Apple has, data in the cloud is encrypted (they removed that option in the UK rather than build in a backdoor as the current regime demanded). Apple and Google also have lockdown modes that make it harder for LEO to access the phones. Apple just recently quietly slid in a feature that reboots the phone if it hasn't contacted the cell network after a certain period of time which makes it even harder to get into.



Kevthehuman • 1y ago

Honestly, fuck google at this point.

Also, For the Gulf of Mexico name change.

But mainly, For breaking basic functionality on my phone. "Call Dad" can't call Dad anymore, as it wants me to add him as my dad but doesn't accept it and forgets immediately. When I do it over voice assistant, it demands to know his name and birthdate, which I won't be providing.

Weirdly enough, "Call Mom" still works to call the contact named "Mom", which isn't of much use to me as she's dead



KingSoupa • 1y ago

[Skip to main content](#)[+ Create](#)**OldManBrodie** • 1y ago • Edited 1y ago

Pixel 10 Pro XL

What haven't you heard? That Google isn't great for privacy? It's pretty widely accepted. They've been fined plenty and been part of privacy lawsuits, including this one, which they settled for \$390M in 2022: <https://www.bbc.com/news/technology-63635380>

I'm deeply embedded in the Google ecosystem, but to pretend like there aren't privacy concerns is staggeringly naïve.

**fuckthehumanity** • 1y ago

Pixel 8 Pro

They're not great with privacy, but they're fantastic with security.

So essentially they'll steal your data, but keep it under lock and key.

**polyblackcat** • 1y ago

Pixel 9 Pro XL

That's probably priority 1, 2, and 3. The ramifications of their security failing are ridiculously huge and you know bad actors are trying 24/7.

**igniteED** • 1y ago

Pixel 6 Pro

Relevant link: [HACKING GOOGLE](#) is a 6 part series of interesting stories around how Google secures your data from hackers.

**germao** • 1y ago

Your working company has your data, the government has your data, the health system has your data, social media has your data, preferences... Do u care about Google having your data? It's a little late for that. I used to be an apple fan boy but switched to pixel 9 pro xl and no regrets. Much more interesting phones, smarter, more usable, look fresh and modern (I got sick of that old iOS UI, the shitty keyboard, the horrible notifications...)

[+ 1 more reply](#)**[deleted]** • 1y ago**BunnyBunny777** • 1y ago • Edited 8mo ago

expansion hard-to-find obtainable strong head quicksand vanish middle literate husky

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to man. The problem is that you can't avoid Google- it's everywhere. Schools use it. Businesses use it. You can't escape Google. It just seems pointless to go out of your way to avoid it. And if you do, it's just a waste of time. All tech companies these days aren't private.

 [+ 3 more replies](#)

 [slayersteve100](#) • 1y ago



[lssong99](#) • 1y ago

Basically I do a dual ecosystem: one is deep integrated with Google and the other is strictly private build around solutions like Owncloud.

If I have things that are not that private then I upload whatever in this category to Google to enjoy the convenience they provided (and use Pi-Hole and Adguard DNS to reduce ad/tracking). Location service is something I gave up to Google since there is no easy way around this and I am not doing top secret missions. (Google already knows where I work/live through previous transactions).

For strictly private issues, I use VPN and connect to my Owncloud instance which runs at my own servers at various locations for backing up. Also, things like photos which I share with Google also backup in my Owncloud.

In this digital age, it's difficult to be absolute private but you can still control where your data is stored.

 [+ 1 more reply](#)



[scots](#) • 1y ago

Pixel 6

Any and every smartphone and "free web apps" you're using are going to track you to varying degrees, and sell your data. Yes, Apple has been caught doing this too.

There really is no viable third option right now unless you want to go down the rabbit hole into full Privacy Nut, and flash your Android phone with a complete de-Google ROM, use encrypted third-party cloud services like Proton's suite, etc.

For Security and Privacy you always have to give up Price and Convenience. Free and Simple is very convenient.



[sebastianbaraj5](#) • 1y ago

As much as I like the pixel phones and it's also my favorite Google product. I can't help but feel like Google is still in this "Beta" or "Early Access" mode kinda like on Steam if any of you do PC gaming. Physical products are basically almost a hit for me. I used to really like googles software a lot but they keep killing projects. They killed their Podcast app last year which was awesome to use.

[Skip to main content](#)[+ Create](#)**PhilosophyCorrect279** • 1y ago

Personally, I am actually impressed at the overall ease of being able to modify and manage my data through Google. They have a whole page with various settings and even other deeper options, to manage what they can and can't use about you. While disturbing, it is better than most companies that don't give you much, if any control whatsoever over your data.

Of which there will always be data collected by someone at some point. So having options to limit what and how much is collected, isn't bad.

**Ferensen** • 1y ago

I'm currently in the process. Why?

1. I pay Google about \$150 each month for accounts (Workspace) and storage (Google One) and other services. The storage capacity is insufficient and soon I will have to optimize (or transfer files elsewhere).
2. Google keeps cancelling services I use (e.g. Google cache) and making decisions I don't agree with. Also the deteriorating corporate culture at Google. The people who work there are now more like IT slaves and have lost their passion for their work (at least that's how I perceive it).
3. Then there's the thing with US politics and the ass-kissing of Trump by Google management. I'm European. The US is hostile to us, so I prefer to give my money to Europeans.

**PhriendlyPhantom** • 1y ago

I don't care tbh. They can have my data if I get to use their services for free

**DDS-PBS** • 1y ago

Pixel 9 Pro

I'm much more concerned about De-Elon-ing my life, but I don't have any control over that.

**dglsfrsr** • 1y ago

I'll be very blunt. Yes, Google harvests data. They certainly do. Clearly they use it for marketing, but here is the rub, I am certain they don't widely share your data with others. Why? Because they would lose their marketing and advertising advantage in the marketplace if other entities had your information. They are the gatekeeper.

Here is the other thing. Apple is also gathering your data for their own internal use. If you think they are not, you are extremely naive. Seriously.

So yes, Google harvests my data. A lot of it you can control, by deep diving into the settings, but the fact is, I like Google maps. I have used others, and they are simply not as good. If you think you have a

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like, to other platforms, but I still have a lot of stuff coming into gmail, and the filtering and searching works pretty well.

Photos. I pay for a little extra storage because Google Photos works so damn well. There are a couple NAS Docker apps that have started to appear that give much of the same search capability, so I may fall over to one of those in the future, but for the last fifteen years, Google photos has served me very well.

Here is another question that I have to ask. Do you have a Facebook account? (I don't) How about X?

How about Reddit? (Oh, yeah, here we are, on Reddit)

If you are on either of X or Facebook, and you are concerned about Google, you have your head in the sand.

**Hook3cho17** • 1y ago

Pixel 9 Pro XL

Did you see what apple did to everyone's privacy with them pulling ADS in the UK? No one's privacy is safe.

**yottabit42** • 1y ago

I think they're paranoid. I gladly give my data to Google for all the great services they provide to make my life easier and more productive. If they want to target ads at me, cool. Sometimes I'll even click the ad to make them more money when it's something I wanted anyway.

Google doesn't sell my personal data. They are also well known for having the best security and practices in the industry.

I would trust Google with my data and security more than any other company I can think of.

**azchavo** • 1y ago

You're basically shifting from one evil to another, makes no difference.

**watergoesdownhill** • 1y ago

People in tech have been trying to do this for at least 10 years.

**That_Car_Dude_Aus** • 1y ago

I live in Australia.



Create



So with like, 4 big data breaches in the last few years and like 15 minor ones that I've got letters about from major corporations, and that's not counting the ones that didn't tell me my data was leaked (as there's also no mandatory reporting)

Well, Google is honestly a safer bet in my eyes.



Expensive-Bed-9169 • 1y ago

Google used to have a motto to do no evil. The changed it so presumably they are happy to be evil now. That includes working for the US government. It is sad.

Of course they are much less evil than Facebook. But still too evil.



[deleted] • 1y ago